

Rep. Tom Emmer on Maria Bartiromo's Wall Street

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MARIA BARTIROMO:

Joining me now is the House Majority Whip, Congressman Tom Emmer. Congressman, it's great to have you this weekend, thank you so much for being here.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Good to see you, Maria, thanks for having me.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

And of course, you and all of your colleagues in the House got so much done before you left for recess, not so for the Senate. We're waiting on the Clarity Act, we're waiting on a number of other things here, Reconciliation 3.0. Of course, I know that they wanted to fund the government so that we don't see a shutdown at the end of September. But Congressman, how would you assess the Senate's work at this point? Isn't it all about the midterms at this point now?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, yes, the midterms obviously are looming large, Maria. But when we talk about the difference between the House and the Senate, just look at what you pointed out. We have passed things that people said there was no way we could get done, starting at the beginning of Donald Trump's term, with just a couple, three, four extra votes every time, sometimes not even a margin, and we get it done. Before we left, just think about what we got done. We got the budget resolution done for 3.0, which is about election integrity, and it's about funding our troops and making sure that our intelligence is funded. We got the NDAA done. We got the Stock Act done. A bunch of huge, heavy lifts in the last week that came out of the House and went over the Senate. And you're asking me to evaluate a body that I'm not in, that I have to work with. But it's very frustrating when we pass these things and nothing happens over on the Senate side. It drags and it drags. And I think clarity might be one of the best examples. The digital assets bill that was passed more than a year ago. And by the way, it's got six or seven years of institutional work in it. On the House side, it was passed more than a year ago with almost a hundred Democrats. And yet it still languishes over in the Senate. They can't seem to get it moved.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

So we are, what, less than 90 days away from the midterms. How are you feeling about holding on to the majority in the House? Obviously, when you look at the other side and these extreme candidates on the left actually could help the Republicans. But typically, the House loses the majority in a presidential term. What are you thinking?

REP. TOM EMMER:

I, when it comes to the actual midterm, I like where we're sitting. People don't realize the map that we've got. We've got 21 opportunities that are Trump seats held by Democrats versus the Democrats who have nine opportunities after redistricting. And I think somebody pointed out in the last week that, in fact, in order for Democrats to flip the House, they would have to win 57 of 77 plus or minus five seats. Maria, that is going to be a very tall order. Again, I feel good about our chances in November.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Yeah, that's very good. I agree on some of those notes. It's the messaging that you need to communicate what you've been able to do. But the Trump administration is also putting a number on its war against fraud. And it's a big one. Vice President J.D. Vance this week saying that his anti-fraud task force has uncovered nearly 230 billion dollars in fraudulent taxpayer funds. Unbelievable. While he says they stopped at least 56 billion dollars more from going out the door. The White House even launching a new online fraud ledger to keep a public record of the eliminated waste. But Vance says executive action can only go so far. Watch this.

J.D. VANCE:

This effort will fundamentally always have a limitation unless our colleagues in the House and the Senate are working with us. We don't want the next administration, whoever, you know, God forbid, you're going to have President el-Sayed in three years. We don't want him to undo all the incredible work that we've been doing. We need our colleagues in Congress to really codify some of this stuff to make sure that it becomes law.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Your reaction, Congressman?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, he's spot on. By the way, fraud is the issue in this election. Minnesota is the poster child of this. Right. Our vice president, when he says he needs our colleagues in Congress to work with us, he's essentially saying, where are the Democrats? We need to do this together. Republicans shouldn't be the only ones touting the attack on trying to make these programs more efficient, fraud free, make sure the benefits are going to the single moms, the disabled children, the people that they're intended for instead of the fraudsters. And that's what he's talking about. We do need Democrats to start stepping up, because quite frankly, this is why I say this is the issue for the midterm. You vote for Republicans. They're going to keep going after this fraud, waste and abuse, which has become endemic under Democrat rule, whether it's at the state level or federally. If you elect Democrats, nothing's going to change. That's what the issue is.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Well, meanwhile, A.I. demand is accelerating and there's political resistance also growing. California Democrat Ro Khanna, a potential twenty twenty eight presidential candidate, is introducing what he's calling a data center bill of rights, pushing Congress to give communities more power to reject new A.I. data center build outs. What do you think about this? Can Washington address the real cost and grid concerns around data centers without slowing America's A.I. build out as China is trying to own this and it's expanding its own capacity?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Ro Khanna, first off, I mean, this is typical of these guys who are trying to position themselves for some other opportunity. He and El Sayed are closer in their beliefs than he is in terms of the constitutional values of this country that our founders said we believe in local control. And I think people have to start reporting and talking

about the fact that not only are we in a race with China when it comes to A.I., when it comes to computing, we're competing with China every day. And you know what they're doing? They're pumping money in with misinformation to this country. They're using our freedoms against us. Our enemy, China, is trying to stop us from beating them in the A.I. war by frustrating our ability to build data centers.

MARIA BARTIROMO:

Yeah, I mean, it is an industrial revolution, part two, with the amount of jobs and build out from these data centers. And it's certainly helping the economy as well. Congressman, we're going to be watching you work on this. So important, all of the above. We so appreciate you joining us this weekend. Thank you.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Thank you, Maria.

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